CREDIT UNIONS vs. BANKS

What's the Difference?

Credit Unions	Banks
Owned by its members	Owned by shareholders or private owners
Serves members and the community	Generates profit for the business/shareholders
Called **members**	Called **customers**
May offer lower loan rates and fewer fees	May have higher fees or interest rates, depending on the bank
Often focused on local/community needs	May serve local, national, or global markets

Key Takeaway

Both credit unions and banks offer financial services like checking accounts, savings accounts, loans, and online banking. The biggest difference is **who owns the institution and who benefits from its success.**